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★★★★ \$5.00

DJIA 46091.74 ▼ 498.50 1.07%

NASDAQ 22432.85 ▼ 1.2%

STOXX 600 561.86 ▼ 1.7%

10-YR. TREAS. ▲ 3/32, yield 4.120%

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GOLD \$4,061.30 ▼ \$7.00

EURO \$1.1582

YEN 155.52

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **A federal judge dismissed** the FTC's claims that Facebook parent Meta has an illegal monopoly in social media, rejecting one of the government's marquee antitrust lawsuits against technology companies. **A1**

◆ **Three of the biggest** companies in AI—Nvidia, Microsoft and Anthropic—announced a partnership featuring tens of billions of dollars in spending. **A1**

◆ **Elon Musk's** artificial intelligence company xAI is in advanced talks to raise \$15 billion in new equity at a \$230 billion valuation. **B1**

◆ **Alphabet's Google** launched Gemini 3, a new version of its large language model, as it tries to catch up to AI rivals. **B1**

◆ **Nvidia's earnings** and the delayed September jobs report this week will provide critical signals for investors. On Tuesday, the Dow, S&P 500 and Nasdaq fell 1.1%, 0.8% and 1.2%, respectively. **B1**

◆ **A Gustav Klimt painting**, "Portrait of Elisabeth Lederer," sold for a historic \$236.4 million at Sotheby's, becoming the most expensive modern artwork at auction, while a solid-gold toilet fetched \$12.1 million. **B1**

◆ **AkzoNobel and Axalta** Coating Systems agree to a merger, creating a global paint giant with a market value of some \$17 billion. **B1**

◆ **Roche shares rose** 6.8% after an experimental pill for breast cancer showed positive results in a late-stage trial. **B2**

◆ **The Trump administration** will give Constellation Energy a \$1 billion federal loan to restart the Three Mile Island nuclear power plant. **A3**

World-Wide

◆ **Congress overwhelmingly** approved legislation mandating the disclosure of a trove of files related to sex offender Jeffrey Epstein. **A6**

◆ **Trump said** Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman "knew nothing about" the 2018 murder of Washington Post journalist Jamal Khashoggi, though the CIA at the time assessed that the royal orchestrated it. **A1**

◆ **The Trump Organization** is planning a Trump-branded resort in the Maldives, partnering with a Saudi-owned developer and using a crypto-like funding vehicle to raise money. **A4**

◆ **A federal court blocked** the use of a new Texas congressional map that was designed at the request of Trump to add GOP House seats. **A3**

◆ **Trump dispatched** a high-level Pentagon delegation to Kyiv for talks Wednesday in an attempt to revive negotiations on halting the war between Ukraine and Russia. **A8**

◆ **Poland accused Russia** of being behind an explosion on its rail network. **A8**

◆ **Airlines and engine makers** are deploying new measures to curb leaking of toxic fumes into cockpits and cabins. **A3**

◆ **The EU is moving** to relax some digital laws in a bid to boost growth and reduce its reliance on U.S. tech. **A9**

◆ **China could exploit** the U.S.'s dependence on Chinese supply chains for key products, according to a new report to Congress. **A6**

◆ **Mexico's president** ruled out allowing U.S. strikes against cartels in Mexico. **A10**

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President Trump with Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman at the White House Tuesday.

Trump Contradicts the CIA In Saudi Journalist's Killing

WASHINGTON—President Trump said Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman "knew nothing about" the 2018 murder of Washington Post journalist Jamal Khashoggi, though the CIA at the time assessed that the royal orchestrated the killing.

By Alexander Ward, Michael R. Gordon and Brian Schwartz

"You're mentioning somebody that was extremely controversial. A lot of people didn't like that gentleman that you're talking about. Whether

you like him or didn't like him, things happen," Trump said Tuesday about Khashoggi after a reporter at the White House asked Mohammed bin Salman about the murder. Turning to his counterpart, Trump said: "But he knew nothing about it."

The crown prince, who returned to the Oval Office for the first time since the killing, replied that, "It's really painful to hear anyone losing his life for no real purpose or not in a legal way," insisting his country had conducted an investigation to ensure nothing like the assassination happens

again. "It's a big mistake."

Khashoggi was a Saudi dissident and U.S. resident who repeatedly spoke out about the kingdom's repressive regime. His grisly murder in a Saudi consulate in Turkey, during Trump's first term led to intense blowback in Washington, with members of both parties calling for severed ties with the kingdom.

"What he's done is incredible in terms of human rights," Trump said, later calling the

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◆ **Trump Organization plans resort in Maldives.....** A4

President's Sway Over GOP Shows First Signs Of Slipping

When White House officials summoned Rep. Lauren Boebert to the White House situation room last week, they hoped that FBI Director Kash Patel and Attorney General Pam Bondi could persuade her not to defy President Trump.

By Aaron Zitner, Josh Dawsey, and Alex Leary

The officials wanted Boebert to back down from supporting a House bill ordering the release of records related to sex offender Jeffrey Epstein. But Boebert, a Republican from Colorado and one of Trump's most vocal supporters, was unpersuaded, administration officials said. She told the room she was concerned about Epstein's victims, wanted to know if others were responsible for abusing girls and didn't trust previous investigations.

Afterward, several administration officials said they had low hopes for the meeting and it had generally been a waste of time.

The episode was one of several recent signs that Trump's ability to bend the Republican Party to his will is weakening. On Tuesday, Congress overwhelmingly voted to release the Justice Department's Epstein files after the president was unable to stop the vote.

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◆ **Congress approves bill to release Epstein files.....** A6

◆ **How Greene went from Trump friend to foe.....** A7

INSIDE



BUSINESS & FINANCE
Gustav Klimt painting sells for a record \$236.4 million at Sotheby's auction. **B1**

Chicken Chain Goes All Out To Keep Its Secret Sauce a Secret

* * *

Raising Cane's ships ingredients in unmarked bags, keeps recipe locked in a safe

By NICHOLAS G. MILLER

Locked in a safe at an undisclosed location sits the key to the success of America's hottest chicken chain.

A list handwritten some 30 years ago by the co-founder of Raising Cane's Chicken Fingers, it is the only physical copy of the recipe for the chain's famous sauce. Few people have ever seen it, and while copycat recipes and alleged leaks from disgruntled employees abound, the company says only those who have seen the list really know how to make Cane's Sauce.

"It's kept with a lot of pride and care and secrecy," co-Chief Executive AJ Kumaran said of the locked-up list.

The safe is just one of several security protocols, from

nondisclosure agreements to unmarked ingredient packages, that Raising Cane's employs to protect the sauce that has helped fuel its growth.

Founded in 1996 by Todd Graves and Craig Silvey, who pitched an idea for a chicken restaurant in a college business class, Raising Cane's has grown to almost 1,000 locations.

The company credits the consistency of its five-item menu. It also has benefited from attention-grabbing ad campaigns with Post Malone and Livvy Dunne and a vibrant store environment that features murals and loud music.

Of course, all that sauce secrecy is also good marketing. In the same way KFC benefited from the mystique

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Meta Wins FTC Suit Alleging It Is a Monopoly

Court ruling denies agency's bid to force unwinding of social-media acquisitions

By DAVE MICHAELS AND MEGHAN BOBROWSKY

WASHINGTON—A federal judge on Tuesday dismissed the Federal Trade Commission's claims that Facebook parent Meta Platforms has an illegal monopoly in social media, rejecting one of the government's marquee antitrust lawsuits against big technology companies.

U.S. District Judge James Boasberg said the FTC didn't prove its claims that Meta's acquisitions of Instagram in 2012 and WhatsApp in 2014 has allowed the company to main-

tain an unlawful monopoly in personal social-networking.

"Whether or not Meta enjoyed monopoly power in the past...the agency must show that it continues to hold such power now," Boasberg wrote in an 89-page decision. "The court's verdict today determines that the FTC has not done so."

The FTC argued that Meta was still a monopolist because its products focused on connecting friends and family, which made them distinct from social-media apps such as TikTok, whose models are built on short-form video entertainment. But during a six-week trial, FTC attorneys often struggled to demonstrate

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◆ **Meta chief revenue officer leaving to form startup... B3**

New AI Partnership Extends Spending Spree

Three of the biggest companies in artificial intelligence said Tuesday they formed a partnership featuring tens of billions of dollars in spending, adding to an investment spree that is aimed at supercharging AI model development.

By Sebastian Herrera, Amrith Ramkumar and Robbie Whelan

Under the partnership, Nvidia and Microsoft will invest up to \$15 billion in Anthropic, a competitor to OpenAI whose models are popular with coders and businesses. Anthropic, in turn, said it would buy \$30 billion of computing capacity from Microsoft Azure running on Nvidia

AI systems. The chip titan will also work with Anthropic on design and engineering.

The alliance is the latest sign in the global AI race that the biggest players must work with one another despite potential business rivalries and policy disagreements. Microsoft is a big investor in Anthropic rival OpenAI and offers its models to customers, while Nvidia Chief Executive Jensen Huang and Anthropic CEO Dario Amodei have clashed over chip exports and the number of jobs lost to AI.

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◆ **Greg Ip: Why dread hangs over AI revolution.....** A2

◆ **Heard on the Street: Nvidia results test AI trade.....** B13

Medicaid Insurers Offer 'Ghost Networks' of Doctors

Many plans list medical professionals who treat few or no patients in the taxpayer-funded program; 'Don't get sick'

Late on a cold afternoon in March, a motorist in Belleville, Ill., came upon a young boy wandering down a busy street without shoes

By Christopher Weaver, Anna Wilde Mathews and Tom McGinty

and wearing only a T-shirt and pajama bottoms.

She called the police. It was at least the fourth time in less than a year that then 8-year-old Trent Davis, who has autism and at-

tention-deficit hyperactivity disorder, had run away from home, police reports show.

His mother, Monique McClure, who had called 911 to report Trent missing, decided after that scare that he needed to see a child psychiatrist who might consider medicine to tame his constant energy and impulsive behavior.

The boy's insurance, a Medicaid health plan from major insurer Centene, has dozens of specialists within 50 miles of her home, according to its website. Today, Trent is stuck

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